Country Summary: New Zealand



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Executive summary of the New Zealand country profile (2026-10-21). Superscript numbers refer to the numbered sources in New Zealand_Profile_DRAFT_SOURCES.docx.

At a Glance

5.36 m Population, 30 June 2026, provisional[3]	**57,350** GDP per capita, PPP (international dollars), about, 2025[6]	**10.06%** Current health expenditure, share of GDP, 2024[37]	**12.7%** Out-of-pocket share of current health expenditure, 2024[39]
3.61 Physicians per 1,000 people, 2022[43]	**82.0** Life expectancy at birth, years, 2024[14]	**17.6%** Population aged 65 and over, 2025[12]	**NZ$34.2 bn** Total health spending, 2026/27, government figure[19]

Country background

New Zealand, a constitutional monarchy with its capital in Wellington, had about 5.36 million people at 30 June 2026 (provisional).[1,3,7] Governor-General Dame Cindy Kiro represents the King, and Prime Minister Christopher Luxon leads a National, ACT and New Zealand First government.[8,9] Simeon Brown is Minister of Health, and Health New Zealand has delivered public services nationally since 2022.[16,19] The high-income economy grew 1.7 percent in the year ended June 2026, and GDP per person was about 57,350 international dollars (PPP) in 2025.[6,20] The population is aging: 17.6 percent were 65 or older in 2025, and life expectancy was 82.0 years in 2024.[12,14] The key risk is fiscal, because the Treasury warns that demographic change, unless checked, will make the long-term fiscal position unsustainable.[21]

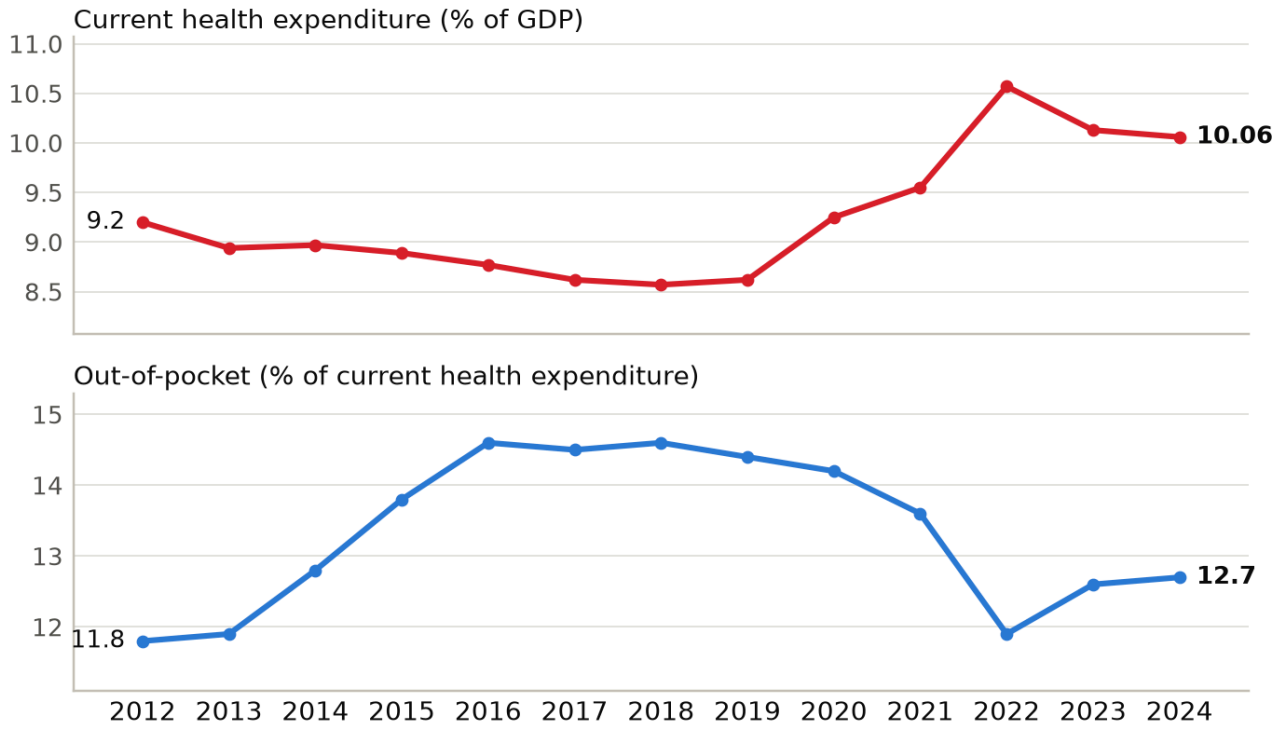
Key takeaways for CSI

- Health spending reached 10.1 percent of GDP in 2024, from 9.2 percent in 2012.[37]
- International graduates were 43.5 percent of registered doctors in 2025, but only 40 percent stay two years.[42]
- In 2024/25, 34.2 percent of adults were obese and 14.3 percent reported high or very high psychological distress.[26]
- In 2026 Health New Zealand signed its first long-term private hospital contracts, worth about $300 million.[36]

Health System

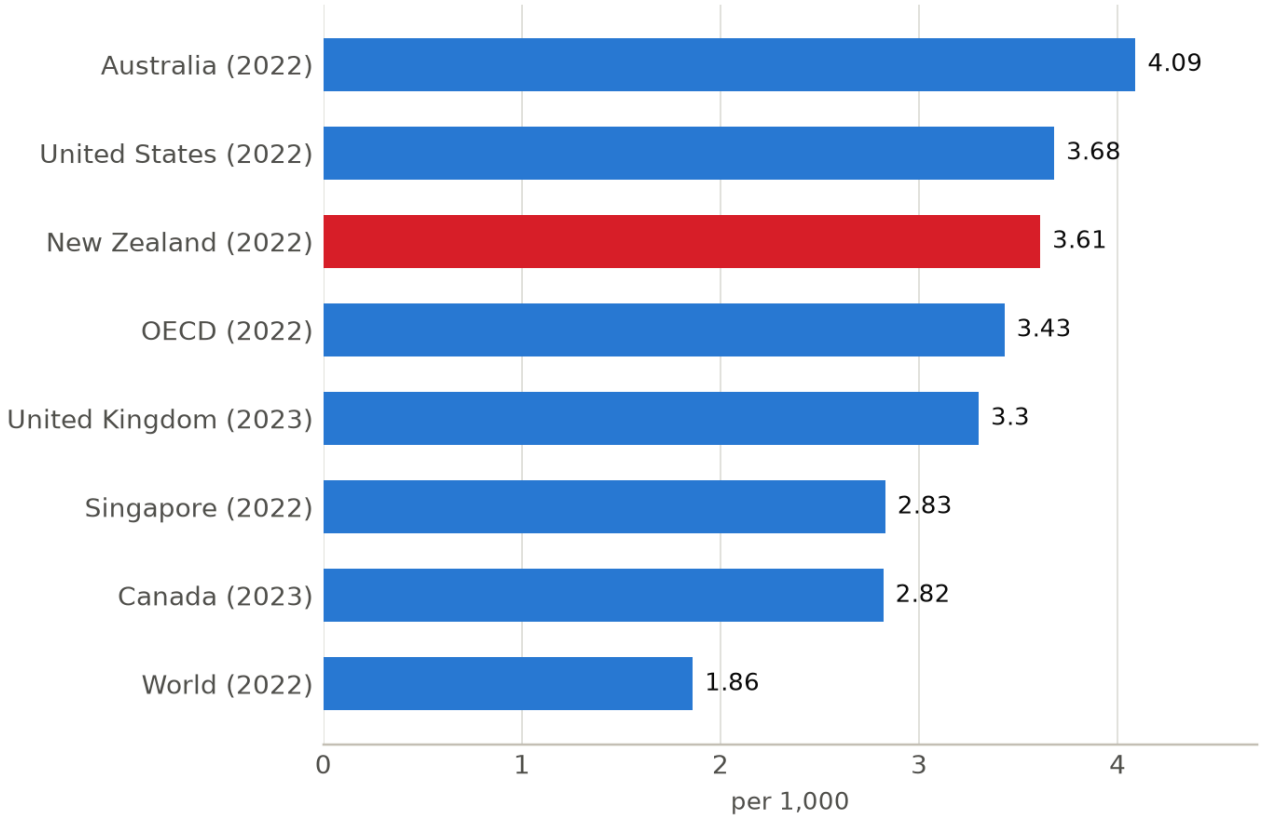
- Health New Zealand replaced the district health boards in 2022 and delivers tax-funded universal care nationally.[16]
- Elective treatment within four months reached 72.6 percent in 2025/26, up from 63.9 percent.[30]
- In 2024/25, cost stopped 14.9 percent of adults visiting a GP, and 25.5 percent cited appointment waits.[26]

New Zealand: health spending and out-of-pocket share, 2012 to 2024



Current health expenditure as a share of GDP, and out-of-pocket spending as a share of current health expenditure. Sources: [37,39]

Physicians per 1,000 people, New Zealand and comparators (latest year available)

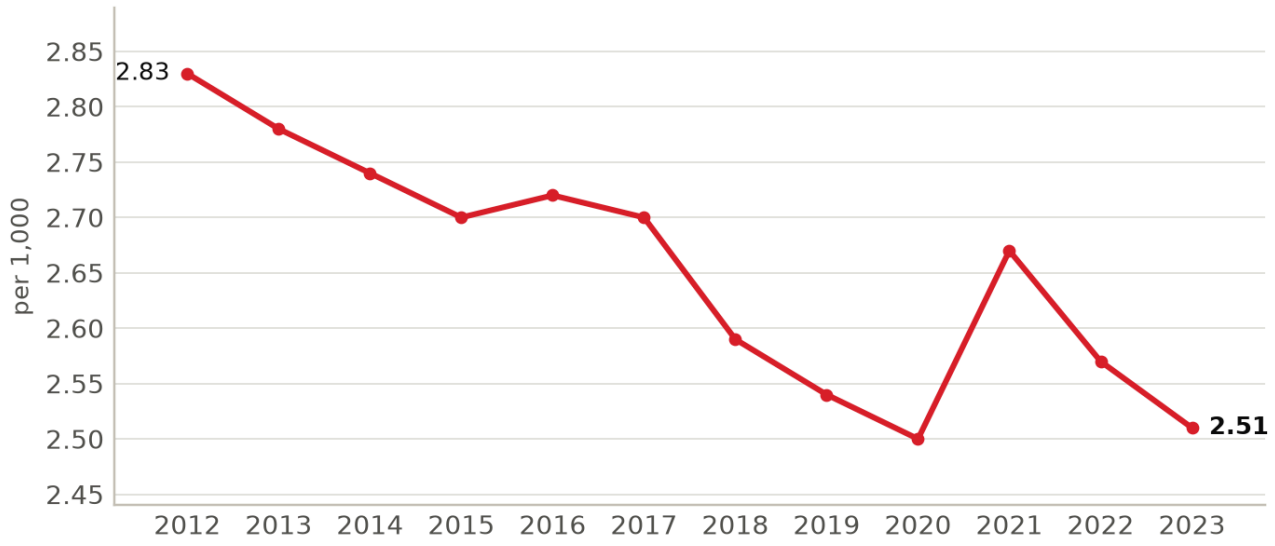


Latest year available for each country in the World Bank series, shown in brackets; comparison years differ (2022 and 2023). Sources: [47]

Market and Competition

- About 37 percent of people hold private insurance, and Southern Cross has about 60 percent of the market.[16,31]
- Icon Oncology Group runs Wellington's Bowen Icon Cancer Centre with Australian-owned Evolution Healthcare.[34,53]
- Health New Zealand signed a digital and AI innovation agreement with London's UCLPartners in July 2026.[56]

New Zealand: hospital beds per 1,000 people, 2012 to 2023



Hospital beds as reported to the World Bank; 2023 is the latest year in the series. Sources: [46]

Foreign health systems active in New Zealand

8 foreign institutions with confirmed active partnerships (8 in all): 4 research collaboration, 2 training and education, 1 ownership or management, 1 advisory and consulting. Sources in the profile and the partnerships tracker.


2
Auckland
2 active
Tauranga
none found
Hamilton
1
1 active
3
Wellington
3 active
Christchurch
none found
2
Dunedin
2 active
Active partnerships (number in circle)
Major metro

Active foreign health-system partnerships by city of the partner in New Zealand. Source: CSI partnerships tracker, verified 2026-10-21. Boundaries: Natural Earth; not an official depiction.

Institution	Nature of collaboration
Johns Hopkins University (Bloomberg School of Public Health, Center for Indigenous Health)	Research collaboration
Icon Oncology Group (Icon Group)	Ownership or management
National University of Singapore and National University Health System	Research collaboration
UCLPartners	Advisory and consulting
Universitas Indonesia (Faculty of Public Health)	Training and education
University of Southampton (MRC Lifecourse Epidemiology Centre, EpiGen Global Research Consortium)	Research collaboration
University of Wollongong (Graduate School of Medicine)	Training and education
West Visayas State University	Research collaboration

CSI Position, Risks and Recent News

CSI partnerships in New Zealand

[MANUAL INPUT REQUIRED]

To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.

Opportunities for CSI

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To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.

Risks and watch items

- A general election is due on 7 November 2026.[9] Its result will shape private outsourcing of elective surgery.
- The Treasury expects superannuation and finance costs to take about 28 percent of tax revenue by 2030/31.[21]
- Practicing nurses fell 4 percent to 80,960 at 30 June 2026, and 43.5 percent qualified overseas.[45]

Recent developments

2026-04-16 Mark Darrow became Health New Zealand board chair on 1 May 2026 for three years, replacing Lester Levy.[28]

2026-05-28 Budget 2026 added more than $5.8 billion in new health operating funding, including a $1.37 billion annual uplift.[19]

2026-10 Health New Zealand reported 87.0 percent of cancer patients treated within 31 days of the treatment decision in 2025/26.[30]